

Project Report

1. INTRODUCTION

Project Overview:

- This project focuses on streamlining and automating the IT procurement process within ServiceNow by targeting standard laptop orders through Flow Designer.
- It bridges manual bottlenecks by automating task creation, assignment, and real-time user notification upon request approval.

Purpose :

- To replace manual, error-prone IT procurement workflows with an efficient, automated mechanism that minimizes administrative overhead.
- To ensure prompt hardware configuration and transparent communication for employees requesting standard laptops

2. IDEATION PHASE

Problem Statement :

- The existing IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays, configuration oversights, and manual tracking overhead for standard laptop orders.
- This manual intervention causes user frustration and inefficient resource allocation across the IT department.

Empathy Map Canvas:

- Say: "Why does it take so long to get a standard laptop configured and assigned?"
- Think: "I wish the IT department automatically picked up my request once approved without me having to follow up."
- Do: Submits catalog requests, tracks order status manually, and sends follow-up emails.
- Feel: Anxious about delays, relieved when automated updates are provided.

Brainstorming :

- Brainstorming ways to utilize ServiceNow Flow Designer to automatically trigger catalog tasks upon approval.
- Introducing an automated email notification action ("Send Email") to instantly update users when their laptop enters the configuration stage.

3. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

Customer Journey map:

- **Discovery:** User logs into the ServiceNow Service Catalog and navigates to the Hardware category.
- **Selection:** Selects "Standard Laptop" (Lenovo Carbon x1) and submits the order.
- **Approval:** Manager reviews and approves the request in ServiceNow.

- **Fulfillment & Notification:** Flow automatically generates a catalog task for the Hardware team and sends a confirmation email to the user.

Solution Requirement :

- ServiceNow instance with Flow Designer enabled.
- Service Catalog item configuration access ("Maintain Items").
- Automated action configuration to handle catalog task creation and email delivery.

Data Flow Diagram:

Service Catalog Order → Approval Stage → Flow Triggered → Catalog Task Created → Hardware Group Assignment → Automated Email Sent to User.

Technology Stack :

- Platform: ServiceNow (Global Application)
- Core Tool: ServiceNow Flow Designer
- Module: Service Catalog, Workflow Engine

4. PROJECT DESIGN

Problem Solution Fit:

Directly solves manual delays by linking Service Catalog requests directly to automated Flow Designer tasks and instant user communication.

Proposed Solution :

Implement a dedicated flow named "Standard Laptop task" that listens to Service Catalog triggers, creates a hardware configuration task, and triggers an automated confirmation email.

Solution Architecture:

Modular integration between the Service Catalog front-end, Flow Designer backend logic, and ServiceNow notification engine.

5. PROJECT PLANNING & SCHEDULING

Project Planning :

- **Phase 1:** Flow Creation & Trigger Configuration ("Service Catalog").
- **Phase 2:** Action Integration (Create Catalog Task with short description, assignment group "Hardware", and approval filters).
- **Phase 3:** Custom Smart Feature Integration (Adding "Send Email" action for "Your Standard Laptop Request is Under Configuration!").
- **Phase 4:** Process Engine Association via Maintain Items.
- **Phase 5:** Testing and Validation via live catalog orders.

6. FUNCTIONAL AND PERFORMANCE TESTING

Performance Testing :

- Evaluated flow execution speed upon manager approval.
- Verified zero latency in triggering catalog tasks and dispatching instant user confirmation emails.

7. RESULTS

The screenshot shows the 'Catalog Item - Standard Laptop' form in ServiceNow. The form is divided into two main sections: 'Item Details' and 'Process Engine'. The 'Item Details' section includes fields for Name (Standard Laptop), Application (Global), Active (checked), Fulfillment automation level (Unspecified), Category (Hardware), State (None), Checked out (None), and Owner. The 'Process Engine' section includes fields for Flow (Standard laptop task), Workflow, and Execution Plan. A blue banner at the top of the form reads: 'Build and modify items faster with the improved Catalog Builder. Catalog items are goods or services available to order from the service catalog. Items can be anything from hardware, like tablets and phones, to software applications, to furniture and office supplies. Enter a Name and Short description to display for the item. Enter a Price, approvals, variables, and other information as needed.'

ServiceNow Catalog Item - Standard Laptop

Build and modify items faster with the improved Catalog Builder.

Catalog items are goods or services available to order from the service catalog. Items can be anything from hardware, like tablets and phones, to software applications, to furniture and office supplies.

- Enter a Name and Short description to display for the item.
- Enter a Price, approvals, variables, and other information as needed.

Name: Standard Laptop

Application: Global

Active: ☒

Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified

Category: Hardware

State: -- None --

Checked out: -- None --

Owner:

Item Details | **Process Engine** | Picture | Pricing | Portal Settings

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow: Standard laptop task

Workflow:

Execution Plan:

The screenshot shows the 'Standard laptop task' workflow in ServiceNow Workflow Studio. The workflow is active and consists of two main sections: 'TRIGGER' and 'ACTIONS'. The 'TRIGGER' section is 'Service Catalog'. The 'ACTIONS' section includes 'Create Catalog Task' and 'Send Email'. The 'Create Catalog Task' action is configured with the following properties: Table Name (Catalog Task [sc_task]), Requested item (Trigger -> Requested item), Short Description (Laptop need to Configured), and Fields (Description: Laptop need to Configured, Assignment group: Hardware, Approval: Approved). The 'Send Email' action is configured with the following properties: email (email) and Action Status (Action Status). The 'Data' panel on the right shows the data flow between the trigger and the actions.

Workflow Studio Standard laptop task

TRIGGER

Service Catalog

ACTIONS

1. Create Catalog Task

Action Properties

Action: Create Catalog Task

Action Inputs

Table Name: Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested item (requested item): Trigger -> Requested item

Short Description: Laptop need to Configured

Fields

Description: Laptop need to Configured

Assignment group: Hardware

Approval: Approved

+ Add field value

2. Send Email

email: email

Action Status: Action Status

Data

Flow variables

Trigger - Service Catalog

Requested item Record

Run Start Time UTC: DateTime

Table Name: Table Name

Run Start Date/Time: DateTime

1 - Create Catalog Task

Catalog Task: Record

Action Status: Object

2 - Send Email

email: Record

Action Status: Object

Status: Published | Application: Global

Requested Item: RITM0010001

Comments (Customer visible):

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Impact: 3 - Low
Opened by: System Administrator
Priority: 4 - Low
State: Open

Field changes: 2026-10-03 03:04:09

Update Delete

Related Links

Flow Control

Catalog tasks (1)

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	[empty]	Laptop need to Configured	2026-10-03 03:07:25	[empty]	

1 to 1 of 1

Catalog Task: SCTASK0010001

Number: SCTASK0010001

Assigned to:

Configuration item:

Active: ☒

Approval: Approved

Priority: 4 - Low

State: Open

Request item: RITM0010001

Requested for: System Administrator

Short description: Laptop need to Configured

Description: Laptop need to Configured

Work notes: Work notes

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Impact: 3 - Low
Opened by: System Administrator
Priority: 4 - Low
State: Open

Field changes: 2026-10-03 03:07:25

Update Close Task Delete

Affected CIs

Configuration Item

ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES:

Advantages

- Streamlines and automates the IT procurement process for standard laptops, eliminating manual delays.
- Reduces manual intervention and minimizes potential configuration errors.
- Ensures prompt hardware configuration upon request approval, reducing overall user wait times.
- Optimizes resource utilization and improves task allocation within the IT department.

- Sends automated confirmation emails ("Your Standard Laptop Request is Under Configuration!") directly to users for enhanced transparency.
- Enhances overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

Disadvantages

- Workflow execution depends on proper ServiceNow Flow Designer and Service Catalog configuration.
- Incorrect or missing initial item attributes may affect task generation.
- Requires appropriate ServiceNow administrative access and role provisioning.
- Changes to approval logic or notification templates require administrative updates in Flow Designer.
- Email delivery relies on active ServiceNow notification engine configurations.

CONCLUSION :

The Automated IT Procurement and Standard Laptop Order System successfully addresses the inefficiencies and manual overhead in handling standard laptop requests within the IT department. By leveraging ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the system automatically creates catalog tasks, assigns them to the hardware group upon approval, and triggers instant email notifications to the requestor.

The implemented solution improves resource utilization, accelerates device configuration, and elevates the user experience by delivering a seamless, transparent, and efficient procurement workflow

FUTURE SCOPE:

- Integrating automated asset tagging and deployment tracking once configuration is closed.
- Expanding the flow framework to cover other peripheral hardware requests (monitors, keyboards, docking stations).

APPENDIX

- **GitHub Link:** <https://github.com/NITHILA-07/ServiceNow-Phasewise-Project.git>
- **Project Demo Link:** https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1aGpmnST0_MJ3gLO9CrJLYSHB_Zf6knBb